> also in Block 14, the Mawi 1 community that asked for a million dollars as indemnity for environmental damages. Also there was a community called Rodrigo Borja where there had been a walkout for work reasons, apparently the Canadians had paid them double, the people of this community alleged that the Chinese exploited them, that they paid little; the Chinese version was that the Ecuadorians were slow and that if it were up to them they would only bring the Chinese down; the people's version was that the Chinese were disorganised and kept the camps dirty.

In the face of these and other conflicts the firms showed little disposition to negotiate. An example of this fact is found in an anecdote of Alexandra Almeida:

> There is a story a friend told me. It appears that they did not satisfy the workers of a community. The people sequestered ten Chinese workers, they grabbed them, this was in Block 7 in Murialba port, the people remained with the Chinese various days and nobody went to complain. They say that the Chinese bosses told them that, if they wanted to keep the Chinese, they would bring more from China where there are millions. A doctor friend who worked for SINOPEC told me this. All the measures that the communities took to pressure them did not work, they worked very long hours all the time with their workers on a very tight schedule.

The companies showed little disposition to deal with those affected or with the workers. This broke with company tendency to seek the sympathy of directly affected local groups through creating clientele relationships: with the Chinese firms there was less willingness to care about their image and they therefore went from having an adequate labour policy to having less good relations with the local communities.

Another ongoing conflict beginning in 2007 resulted in the dismissal of many Andes Petroleum Consortium workers operating in Block 14–17 Shiripuno when labour outsourcing was prohibited. The workers claim that the criteria used to fire them were discriminatory and not work-related and thus demanded payment for the earnings that the firm has not handed over. Their legal representative stated that the firm continues to outsource workers: 'To the south of Dayuma parish there are many oil companies that are outsourcers, the Ministry of Labour Relations of Orellana has not done any supervision, at the end of the day the people work and like this break the labour code. The workers never gain access to a copy of the contracts.'[6]